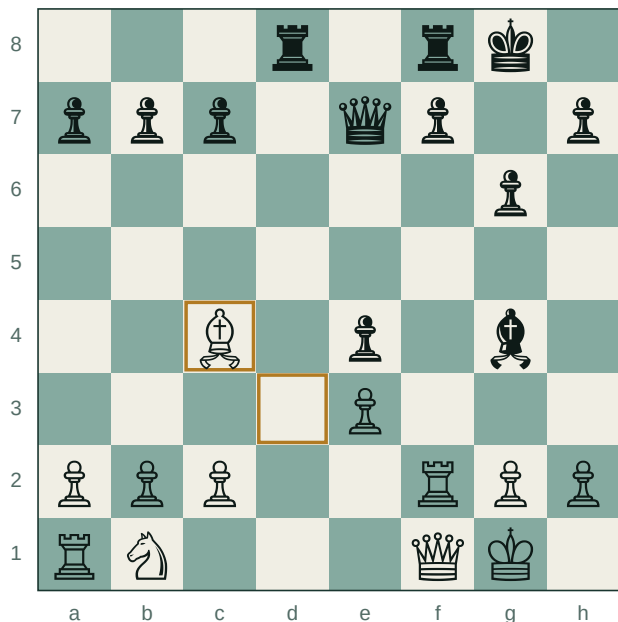


Pins and pressure: Black, move 17

Pins and pressure

Black to move



Previous move: 17.Bc4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

17...Rd1 18. Qxd1 Bxd1

17...Rd1 The rook moves from d8 to d1. From d1 it attacks queen on f1 and knight on b1. Recorded reply: **18.Qxd1**.

18...Bxd1 The bishop captures the queen on d1.

At the end, nominal material is White 22 / Black 24 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +4:** the balance goes from -2 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A pinned piece can sometimes move along the line, capture the pinning piece, or answer with a forcing resource.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A pin limits a piece because moving it exposes a more important target. A pin to the king restricts legality; a pin to another piece changes the practical cost of moving.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the line through attacker, pinned piece, and rear target. Test whether the pinned piece is being counted as a defender it cannot really be.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: rook on a1. Check for tactical protection.